Mapping the spread of antisemitic narratives

Kornstein Lab for Antisemitism Research

Research proposal

Abstract

This proposed study examines how antisemitic narratives recur and change across online discourse. It combines text analysis and network methods while distinguishing observed connections from claims about influence.

1 Introduction

We propose to examine recurring narratives and their temporal relationships across sampled online discourse. The aim is to describe observable patterns without treating similarity as evidence of coordination.

2 Network framework

An illustrative thresholded similarity network is

$$A_{ij}(t) = \mathbf{1}\{s_{ij}(t) \geq \tau\}, \qquad i \neq j.$$

Here, $s_{ij}(t)$ denotes a specified similarity measure at time t and τ a chosen threshold. An edge represents similarity under this definition; it does not establish influence or causal transmission.

3 Proposed methodology

1. Corpus construction.
2. Narrative identification.
3. Temporal network analysis.

4 Limitations

Missing observations, repeated quotations, and threshold choices may alter network structure. Sensitivity analysis and contextual review would be required. This proposal reports no empirical network findings.